FOUNDER & PROMOTER BRIEFING • 2026 EDITION

The Founder's Guide to Zero-Retainer Contingency Hiring

Candidate Vetting SLAs, Vacancy Cost Financial Drag Models, and the 90-Day Replacement Shield for High-Stakes Leadership Roles (₹12 LPA to ₹1 Cr).

₹0	7 Days	90 Days
UPFRONT RETAINER FEE	3 BLIND FINALIST DOSSIERS SLA	CANDIDATE REPLACEMENT SHIELD

1. The Retained Executive Search Model Teardown

Traditional executive search agencies demand a 33% upfront retainer fee regardless of outcome: one-third paid at contract signing, one-third at shortlist delivery, and the final third upon offer issuance. When a role remains vacant for 60 to 90 days, or when an executive candidate ghosts on Day 1, the employer absorbs 100% of the operational loss.

The Three Sunk Capital Risks of Retained Search

1. Advance Capital Lockup: Paying ₹3,00,000 to ₹10,00,000 in retainers before reviewing a single vetted candidate dossier creates zero performance urgency for the agency.

2. 60–90 Day Timeline Drag: Traditional search agencies run prolonged research phases while your production lines, engineering delivery, or regional sales sit unmanaged.

3. No Protection Against Day-1 Ghosting: If an accepted candidate takes a counter-offer on their joining date, retained agencies retain your advance and restart their lengthy process without financial penalty.

2. The JSM Zero-Retainer Contingency Model

JSM Integrated Services aligns executive search incentives with business reality. We operate on a **100% Success-Based Contingency Placement Model**:

₹0 Upfront Retainer

Zero advance fees. Our recruitment desk initiates candidate mapping, discrete interviews, and dossier preparation at our own financial risk.

Invoiced Strictly Post-Joining

Our standard 8.33% contingency fee `[CONFIRM: fee %]` is invoiced only after the executive joins

your organization, backed by Net 15/30 credit terms.

3. Candidate Vetting Service Level Agreements (SLAs)

We replace vague recruitment promises with contractual turnaround commitments across every mandate from ₹12 LPA to ₹1 Cr [CONFIRM: role band].

SLA 1: 15-Minute Mandate Calibration

TURNAROUND: DAY 1

No lengthy, generic 10-page job descriptions. We conduct a structured 15-minute operational briefing with the Promoter, Plant Head, or HR Director to calibrate:

- [CHECK] Exact operational deliverables (scrap reduction, line OEE targets, team restructuring, revenue milestones).
- [CHECK] Hard non-negotiables: specific industry tenure, verified shop-floor credentials, and reporting lines.
- [CHECK] Confidential compensation boundaries (₹12L to ₹1Cr [CONFIRM: role band]) and notice period buy-out parameters.

SLA 2: 7-Day 3-Blind-Dossier Sprint

TURNAROUND: GUARANTEED BY DAY 7

Within 7 business days of calibration, our desk delivers exactly 3 pre-vetted, interview-ready candidate dossiers:

- [CHECK] **Blind Confidential Format:** Identifies achievements, team size, and P&L scale while protecting passive candidate discretion.
- [CHECK] **Audited Track Record:** Verification of scrap metrics, OEE improvements, and past employer tenure.
- [CHECK] **Confirmed Financials:** Verified current compensation, expected fixed/variable CTC, and confirmed notice period.

SLA 3: 48-Hour Interview Scheduling Window

TURNAROUND: WITHIN 48 HOURS

Once an employer greenlights a dossier, our desk coordinates direct Promoter or MD interviews within 48 hours. Rapid interview momentum eliminates candidate drop-off and prevents counter-offers.

4. Retained Agency vs JSM Contingency Model

HIRING DIMENSION	TRADITIONAL RETAINED SEARCH	JSM INTEGRATED SERVICES
Upfront Capital	33% Advance retainer required	**₹0 Advance Retainer (Pure Contingency)**
Shortlist Delivery	30 to 60 Days average	**7-Day 3-Blind-Dossier Sprint SLA**

HIRING DIMENSION	TRADITIONAL RETAINED SEARCH	JSM INTEGRATED SERVICES
Invoicing Milestone	1/3 kickoff, 1/3 shortlist, 1/3 offer	Strictly Net 15/30 days post-joining [CONFIRM: fee %]
Placement Fee	15% – 25% of annual CTC	**8.33% of Annual CTC [CONFIRM: fee %]**
Replacement Guarantee	30 Days (partial credit note)	**90-Day Free Candidate Replacement Shield [CONFIRM: fee %]**

5. The True Cost of an Open Leadership Role

Business owners often view hiring fees as an expense while ignoring the invisible operational drain of an empty executive desk. An open leadership position causes line scrap escalation, supervisor overtime, and delayed customer dispatches.

The Daily Cost of Vacancy (COV) Formula

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Daily Vacancy Drag = (Annual Operational Value of Role / 220 Working Days) + Supervisory Drag
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For a Plant Manager or Operations Head (Band 1/2: ₹18L–₹35L CTC [CONFIRM: role band]), the benchmark financial drag is **₹35,000 per working day** in unrecovered overhead, scrap penalties, and production downtime.

6. Comparative Financial Analysis: 60-Day Retained vs JSM 7-Day Sprint

Traditional 60-Day Retained Delay

₹21,00,000 Loss

Vacancy Drag: 60 Days × ₹35,000/day = ₹21,00,000

Upfront Retainer: ₹3,00,000 to ₹5,00,000 paid at Day 1

Total Operational Sunk Capital: ₹24,00,000+

JSM 7-Day Contingency Sprint

₹18,55,000 Saved

Shortlist Delivered: Day 7 (Vacancy drag: ₹2,45,000)

Days Saved: 53 Days of operational recovery

Direct Net Savings: 53 × ₹35,000 = **₹18,55,000**

7. Daily Vacancy Drag Across Executive Role Bands

ROLE COMPENSATION BAND	DAILY VACANCY DRAG	30-DAY DRAG LOSS	60-DAY DRAG LOSS	JSM 7-DAY SAVINGS
Band 1: Mid-Senior (₹15 LPA) Plant Mgr / Tech Architect [CONFIRM: role band]	₹22,000 / day	₹6,60,000	₹13,20,000	**₹11,66,000**
Band 1/2: Operations Head (₹25 LPA) General Mgr Ops [CONFIRM: role band]	**₹35,000 / day**	₹10,50,000	**₹21,00,000**	**₹18,55,000**
Band 2: Functional Head (₹40 LPA)	₹55,000 / day	₹16,50,000	₹33,00,000	**₹29,15,000**

ROLE COMPENSATION BAND	DAILY VACANCY DRAG	30-DAY DRAG LOSS	60-DAY DRAG LOSS	JSM 7-DAY SAVINGS
VP Engineering / Ops [CONFIRM: role band]				
Band 3: Executive CXO (₹75 LPA – ₹1 Cr) CEO / COO / MD [CONFIRM: role band]	₹1,10,000 / day	₹33,00,000	₹66,00,000	**₹58,30,000**

8. The 90-Day Free Replacement Guarantee Terms

Our commitment to operational continuity extends beyond the joining date. Every executive placement is shielded by our 90-Day Guarantee:

Terms of the 90-Day Replacement Shield

1. 100% Free Replacement Sprint: If a placed candidate resigns, fails probation, or experiences health incapacity within 90 calendar days of joining, JSM initiates an immediate priority sprint to provide a replacement at **₹0 additional fee** [CONFIRM: fee %].

2. No Credit Notes or Delays: Unlike traditional agencies that issue non-refundable credit vouchers, JSM immediately activates active candidate matching within 48 hours of notification.

3. Post-Joining Invoicing: Placement fees (8.33% fixed CTC [CONFIRM: fee %]) are invoiced Net 15 or 30 days from joining, ensuring the candidate is actively delivering before your accounting settlement.

9. The 4-Step Protocol to Eliminate Day-1 Ghosting

Senior candidate ghosting occurs when communication lapses during notice periods. JSM executes a rigorous 4-step transition protocol:

Step 1: Resignation Verification

Candidate provides formal proof of resignation submission and acceptance within 48 hours of offer letter countersigning.

Step 2: Weekly Touchpoint Cadence

Our desk maintains weekly structured check-ins during the notice period, monitoring counter-offer attempts and family relocation logistics.

Step 3: Buy-Out Settlement

If a current employer holds notice period release, JSM negotiates formal buyout terms to expedite line handover.

Step 4: Day-1 On-Site Escort

JSM desk confirms candidate physical muster at your facility on Day 1, verifying on-site onboarding with your HR team.

Initiate a 7-Day Contingency Mandate

Initiate your executive search with ₹0 upfront retainer. Book a 15-minute mandate calibration with our executive desk today.

Executive Desk: **+91 90808 63448**
Direct Email: **contact@jsmintegratedservices.com**

Registered Office: **Door No.: 87, Plot No: 112, Gandhi Nagar,**
Kottapattu, Tiruchirappalli - 620021, Tamil Nadu
Web Portal: **https://www.jsmintegratedservices.com**